MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-004: The Queens Grace Residency Track

Canon Lock v1.4. Creator Ruling B. Resolves MA-003 §3 (pending); amends MA-002 §4

STATUS: LOCKED IN. The creator chose **Option B**. The Queens Grace Hospital General Surgery Residency is a **7-year academic track**: **5 clinical years plus 2 integrated research years**. The original intern class starts on **Friday, July 1, 2005** and finishes residency on **Saturday, June 30, 2012**, at the **end of Season 8**. That matches their Grey's Anatomy counterparts exactly.

1. Why It's Realistic

- Academic surgery programs in the US commonly built 1-2 dedicated research years into general surgery training, which made 7-year residencies standard at research-heavy teaching hospitals in 2005.
- Queens Grace is a **teaching hospital and Level I trauma center** (MA-001 §4) that wants to compete with Manhattan programs, so a mandatory research track fits its identity and its pride.
- **The integrated model:** research years at Queens Grace are *not* spent away in a lab. Residents carry a research title and a protected research project, and they also keep taking call, scrubbing in and covering the floors. This keeps the whole class in the hospital, and on screen, every season.
- **No-Nerf compliance:** a research year does not slow anyone down. Clinical rank stays where it is, but surgical skill, reputation and ambition keep growing, and the research itself becomes a competitive arena (papers, grants, firsts).

2. The Class Ladder (Original 2005 Intern Class)

Szn	Academic year	Track year	Official title	Clinical level	Year-end milestone
1-2	2005-06	Year 1	Intern	PGY-1	Intern year completed
3	2006-07	Year 2	Research Resident I (integrated)	Junior (PGY-1 level)	USMLE Step 3 and the program's advancement exam; pass to move up to PGY-2
4	2007-08	Year 3	Surgical Resident	PGY-2	First year teaching a new intern class
5	2008-09	Year 4	Surgical Resident	PGY-3	Specialty interests take shape

Szn	Academic year	Track year	Official title	Clinical level	Year-end milestone
6	2009-10	Year 5	Research Resident II (integrated)	PGY-3 level	Research presented; the Hudson Mercy merger lands this year
7	2010-11	Year 6	Senior Resident	PGY-4	Chief resident selection
8	2011-12	Year 7	Senior Resident / Chief Resident	PGY-5	Residency completed June 30, 2012; board qualifying exam; fellowships and jobs
9+	2012-13 onward	Post-residency	Fellows / Attendings	n/a	Per character sheets

The research years fall in Seasons 3 and 6, the seasons where the counterpart class holds its rank rather than advancing. That keeps each season's class level equivalent to Grey's while every date stays real. Each July 1 turnover happens in the summer gap between seasons. The exception is the turnover at the start of the track, July 1, 2005, which is S1E1 itself.

3. Key Dates

Date	Event
Friday, July 1, 2005	First day of the intern year. S1E1.
Saturday, July 1, 2006	Move to Research Year I (between Seasons 2 and 3)
Sunday, July 1, 2007	Promotion to PGY-2 (between Seasons 3 and 4)
Tuesday, July 1, 2008	Promotion to PGY-3 (between Seasons 4 and 5)
Wednesday, July 1, 2009	Move to Research Year II (between Seasons 5 and 6)
Thursday, July 1, 2010	Promotion to PGY-4 (between Seasons 6 and 7)
Friday, July 1, 2011	Promotion to PGY-5 / Chief (between Seasons 7 and 8)
Saturday, June 30, 2012	Residency completed (end of Season 8)

Later intern classes follow the same 7-year track from their own July 1 start date unless their character sheet logs a deviation (transfer, repeated year, leave of absence, or a move to a different program).

4. Age Math Reminder

The track runs 7 years, so a character who starts as a 26-year-old intern on July 1, 2005 will be 32 or 33 on June 30, 2012, depending on their birthday. All ages are calculated from birthdays on the date of each scene (MA-001 §8).

5. Amendments and Canon Log

Item	Change / fact
MA-002 §4	Default progression replaced by the MA-004 §2 ladder.
MA-003 §3	Graduation-timing ruling is **resolved: Option B**. Class levels for Seasons 3-8 are now locked.
C-014	The QGH General Surgery Residency is a 7-year academic track: 5 clinical years plus 2 integrated research years.
C-015	Research years: AY 2006-07 (S3) and AY 2009-10 (S6). Residents stay clinically active in the hospital.
C-016	The original class finishes residency on June 30, 2012, at the end of Season 8.
C-017	Chief resident selection happens at the end of AY 2010-11 (S7). The chief year is AY 2011-12 (S8).

END OF MA-004. CANON LOCKED (v1.4).
Seven years, one class, nobody nerfed. The ladder is built, so bring the people who'll climb it.